# Lab 02 — Plan the Story with Claude and the Storytelling Skill

**Course:** Agentic AI for Video Creation (C436)

**Day 1 · Topic 1 · about 50 minutes · slides 71–77**

**Agent:** Claude Desktop — the storytelling skill

**Features:** Prompt Builder · creative brief · 60-second script · script review for edits · quality-issue forecast

## The story so far

Priya wants Episode 1, The Rainy-Day Tin, live in two weeks. Before anyone spends a Higgsfield credit, the story has to work on paper — and you need to know which edits and which quality risks each scene will bring.

## Your goal

Use one AI agent and one skill to turn an idea into a brief and a timed script, then review the script to decide the edits each scene needs.

## You'll produce

01-idea__brief, 01-idea__script-v1 and 01-idea__script-review saved to the project knowledge

## What is in this folder

- `assets/episode-01-idea.pdf`
- `assets/script-review-template.pdf`
- `assets/sample/script-v1.pdf`
- `assets/sample/script-review.pdf`
- `prompts.html` — open in a browser; one click copies each prompt into Claude
- `prompts.pdf` — the same prompts, printable
- `evidence/checklist.pdf` — what to capture as proof
- `../prompt-builder.html` — build your own prompt for any stage, genre and platform

## Why each step matters

- One agent is enough here. Planning is a single line of thought — brief, script, review — and the storytelling skill gives Claude the studio's structure for a micro-drama: hook in three seconds, set-up, turn, choice, payoff, end card.
- The Prompt Builder holds a template for every stage, genre and platform. You change the words in [BRACKETS]; the structure that makes the prompt work stays put.

- The brief comes before the script because it fixes the audience, the one message and the rules. A script written without a brief drifts into generic money tips.
- The script review is the skill at work here: reading a script and deciding which edits will deliver the creative vision — a match cut between the tin and the banking app, a montage for "six months later", a text overlay for the rule.
- Your decision step matters. Claude proposes; the producer decides. Record why you rejected a suggestion — that note is evidence of judgement.

## Step by step

1. **Open the project** — Start a new chat inside the Ep1 project. Attach episode-01-idea.pdf.
2. **Build the prompt** — Open prompt-builder.html: Stage Story, Genre Micro-drama, Platform TikTok. Fill the brackets, Copy, paste — or use Prompt A.
3. **Brief first** — Prompt A calls the storytelling skill for the creative brief. Correct anything that breaks the studio rules.
4. **Write the script** — Prompt B: six timed scenes, voice-over, on-screen text and sound for 60 seconds.
5. **Review for edits** — Prompt C: for every scene Claude names the edit types it needs and why.
6. **Forecast quality issues** — Prompt D: the quality issues most likely in each scene and how to prevent them.
7. **Decide as the producer** — Accept or reject at least two suggestions. Save the three files to project knowledge with the 01-idea__ prefix.

## The prompts

### PROMPT A — creative brief (storytelling skill)

> Use the storytelling skill. Read the studio brief in this project and the attached episode idea.
>
> Write a one-page creative brief for Episode 1, "The Rainy-Day Tin": audience, the one message, platform and format (TikTok, 9:16, 60 seconds), tone, logline, characters, call to action, must include, must avoid.
>
> Rules: general money education only. No product names, no promised returns, no numbers we cannot source. Ask me up to three questions before you write if anything is unclear.

### PROMPT B — the 60-second script

> Using the approved brief, write the script for Episode 1.
>
> Six scenes, timed to exactly 60 seconds:
> hook (0-5s), set-up, turn, choice, payoff, end card (55-60s).
>
> For each scene give: time range, what we SEE, voice-over or dialogue, on-screen text, and sound (music cue or effect).
> Keep spoken lines short — under 140 words in total.

> End card: "Start your rainy-day tin this payday." plus the disclaimer from the studio brief.

**PROMPT C — script review for edits**

> Review script-v1 as a video editor before production.
>
> Make a table, one row per scene: scene, what the scene must make the viewer feel, the edit types it needs (for example cut, cutaway or B-roll, match cut, montage, J or L cut, text overlay, speed ramp, transition, music cue), and why each edit serves the story.
>
> Then list two scenes where a different edit would be stronger, and say what you would change.

**PROMPT D — quality-issue forecast**

> For the same six scenes, forecast the quality issues we are most likely to meet when Higgsfield generates this episode.
>
> Group them as: technical (picture and sound), AI generation (for example face drift, extra fingers, garbled text), story and continuity, and compliance (music rights, disclaimer, misleading money claims).
>
> For each issue give the scene, how we would notice it, and one way to prevent it in the prompt or the edit.

## Check your work

- ☐ The brief names one audience, one message and the must-avoid rules.
- ☐ The script has six scenes that add up to exactly 60 seconds.
- ☐ The end card carries the call to action and the disclaimer.
- ☐ The script review lists the edit types for every scene, with a reason for each.
- ☐ The quality forecast covers all four groups of issues.
- ☐ You accepted or rejected at least two suggestions and wrote why.

## If it goes wrong

- **Claude invents statistics** — Reply: "Remove every number you cannot source. Use general wording instead."
- **The script runs long** — Ask for a word count per scene and a 140-word cap; spoken English runs about 2.5 words a second.

## Stretch

- Ask Claude for a 30-second cut-down of the same script and compare which scenes survive.

> **The cheapest place to fix a video is the script. Every edit you decide now is a Higgsfield credit you will not spend later.**

## Next

Lab 03 — Storyboard Artifact, Editing Standards and Work Plan. Keep what you produced — the next lab starts from it.

## Safety

Use only this lab's fictitious characters and data and your own accounts. Never paste an API key, password or personal data into a prompt, a file you share or a screenshot. Nothing is uploaded publicly; upload plans stay private until a person approves.